

same congestion pattern. For this reason, the peaks marked A and B in the figure are not part of a double top.

Top high price. The price difference between the two peaks is usually minimal (the median is 1%). The key is that the two peaks should appear to peak at or near the same price. The two Adam tops shown in [Figure 30.4](#), for example, have a 4% price variation.

[Table 30.1](#) Identification Guidelines

Characteristic	Discussion
Appearance	Adam tops are narrow price spikes, inverted V's. Both should appear similar.
Price trend	Price trends upward leading to the pattern and should not form a third peak, nor should the twin peaks be part of the same consolidation pattern. Look for two distinct minor highs.
Valley between tops	Patterns with a large dip (a tall pattern) perform better than short ones.
Top high price	Top-to-top price variation is small.
Top separation	Tops should be at least a few weeks apart, but be flexible.
Price decline after right top	Price must close below the confirmation price without first rising above the pattern.
Volume	Usually higher on the left top but volume trends downward from peak to peak.
Breakout direction, confirmation	Breaks out downward when price closes below the lowest valley between the two tops. A downward breakout confirms the double top as a valid chart pattern.